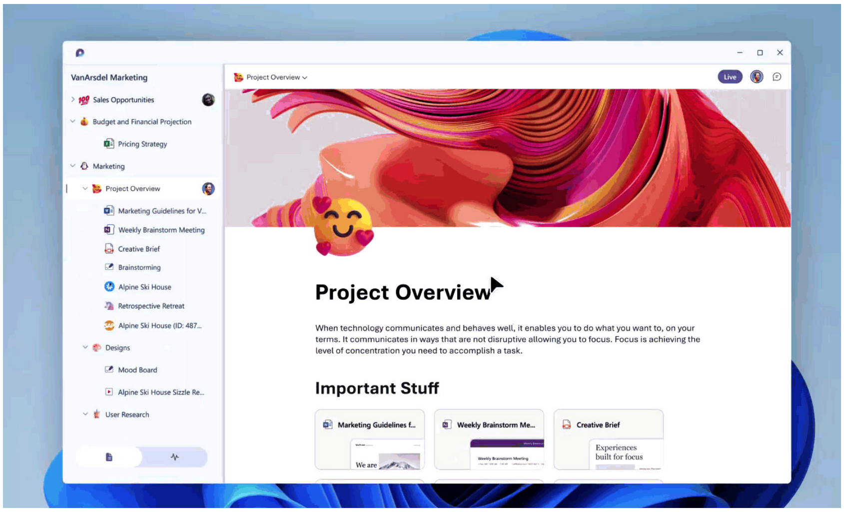
Microsoft launches open source real-time collaboration tool called 'Loop'



Microsoft has launched its own version of Google Wave – Microsoft Loop, a new Office collaboration app.

According to *TechCrunch*, Loop is a new app — and concept — that takes the Fluid framework, which provides developers with flexible components to mix and match in order to create real-time editing-based applications, to create a new experience for users to collaborate on documents.

In many ways, that was also the promise of Google Wave — real-time collaboration plus a developer framework and protocol to bring Wave everywhere, the report said.

Google Wave was a doomed real-time messaging and collaboration platform Google launched in 2009 and prematurely shuttered in 2010.

There are three elements to Loop — Loop components, which are 'atomic units of productivity' like lists, tables, notes and tasks; Loop pages — "flexible canvases where you can organise your components and pull in other useful elements like files, links, or data to help teams think, connect, and collaborate;" and Loop workspaces. These are shared spaces where you can catch up on what everybody is working on and track the progress towards shared goals.

One thing Wave never had that is apparently a core feature of Loop is that the latter tracks your cursor position in real-time, the report said.

Linux Foundation enhances security to its LFX Community Platform

The Linux Foundation, the non-profit organisation enabling mass innovation through open source, has enhanced its free LFX security offering so that open source projects can secure their code and reduce non-inclusive language.

The LFX platform hosts community tools for security, fundraising, community growth, project health, mentorship and more. It supports projects and empowers open source teams to write better, more secure code, drive engagement and grow sustainable ecosystems.

Airbnb open sources serverless public key framework Ottr

Airbnb has announced open source Ottr, a serverless public key infrastructure (PKI) framework developed in-house. Ottr handles end-to-end certificate rotations without the use of an agent. Its primary design aims to be a scalable and configurable serverless framework on AWS, with little operational overhead or reliance on enrolment protocols.

Ottr can be extended to handle end-to-end certificate rotations for any hosts (e.g., network infrastructure, Linux, Windows) capable of managing their own X.509 certificates from a remote session (e.g., API, SSH, SSM Agent).

While there are a number of agent-based solutions to automate certificate rotations for Linux and Windows distributions, the process to broker certificates for network infrastructure commonly involves either manual intervention from engineering teams or use of enrolment protocols such as Certificate Management Protocol (CMP), Simple Certificate Enrolment Protocol (SCEP), or Enrolment over Secure Transport (EST), all of which have security issues.

airbnb

Ottr was built to abstract away a number of challenges associated with certificate provisioning while also providing additional benefits around operations and security.